# Submission Worksheet

## Submission Data

**Course:** IT265-002-S2026
**Assignment:** IT265 Design Treatment Checkpoint
**Student:** Abiodun O. (ao433)
**Status:** Submitted | **Worksheet Progress:** 100%
**Potential Grade:** 10.00/10.00 (100.00%)
**Received Grade:** 0.00/10.00 (0.00%)
**Started:** 3/10/2026 6:05:54 AM
**Updated:** 3/10/2026 10:32:42 AM
**Grading Link:** https://learn.ethereallab.app/assignment/v3/IT265-002-S2026/it265-design-treatment-checkpoint/grading/ao433
**View Link:** https://learn.ethereallab.app/assignment/v3/IT265-002-S2026/it265-design-treatment-checkpoint/view/ao433

## Instructions

**Objective:** Individually create a detailed design treatment for an original board game, covering the concept, gameplay mechanics, visual style, target audience, and inclusivity features. This foundational work will lead to further development phases.

1. Work on the below tasks (recommended to do in the order provided). 2, After you have the core concepts/sketches seek external feedback from 3 different people, preferably people from your target audience
2. Once all items are filled out, ensure this worksheet is saved and explore the PDF
3. Upload the PDF to a branch called `DesignTreatment` on GitHub
4. Create a pull request to main, and complete the merge
5. Upload the same PDF to Canvas

# Section #1: ( 2 pts.) Crafting The Game Treatment

Progress: 100%

## Task #1 ( 0.29 pts.) - Possible Title(s) of the Game

Progress: 100%

**Details:**

- Propose fitting title(s) reflecting the game's essence
- Explanation of title(s) choices

Your Response:

Hexal Miners: The word “hexal” is an offshoot word from the shape “hexagon” as I

want my game board to be entirely made of hexagonal tiles. Also the word “miners” is included because they represent the main characters for my game.

Caved In: This name refers to a structure or ground collapsing inward. Since my game will be using Miners as player tokens, the name choice comes across being ironic for highlighting the cruel situation the miners are in.

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## Task #2 ( 0.29 pts.) - Game Setting

Progress: 100%

**Details:**

- Thoroughly describe the setting

Your Response:

The game’s setting takes place during the mid-20th century in Nevada as the area still participated in traditional, labor-intensive mining to gather minerals and other geological resources with the use of a simple pickaxe. Technology was supremely limited around those times, making it easy to succumb to the dangers caves presented.

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## Task #3 ( 0.29 pts.) - Game Characters

Progress: 100%

**Details:**

- Thoroughly describe the characters

Your Response:

The characters in my game are made up of extremely talented people enrolled in the occupations you'd expect to see from traditional mining. There are Blasters named Dyne and Powwow in charge of priming explosives into blastholes or prepared cave structures ready to be blown up. Hewers named Hatchet and Brine whose responsibility is to garner minerals using a shovel or pickaxe. And lamproom men named Ernie and Sal whose job relies on maintaining and distributing lamps to workers in the mine.

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## Task #4 ( 0.29 pts.) - Game Theme

Progress: 100%

**Details:**

- Thoroughly describe the theme

Your Response:

As my game entirely takes place in an underground mine, I'd like to incorporate the theme of existential dread as it describes the predicament the miners face once reaching the turning point of their story. The sheer dread one might experience mining in an volatile environment where anything can happen is a theme all too familiar to the common man. The underground mine is symbolic to the sense of despair and imbues hopelessness that could suck you into the dank unknown without a possibility for a way out.

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## Task #5 ( 0.29 pts.) - Game Story

Progress: 100%

**Details:**

- Thoroughly describe the story

Your Response:

My game's story begins on a typical evening in the Nevada Black Rock Desert where a mining site is in high powered operation. Various miner types on the site were arduously working in tandem to complete the designated quota they had for the day. In the midst of work frenzy, a Blaster unit primed and blew up a blasthole without the proper go-ahead from his superior. Suddenly, the ground gave way to the explosion and sank under all miner units within the area underground. Once the fatal disaster was over, the miners who managed to recover from their injuries were in a cave-in, dusky environment with no visible way out. However, some of the tools scattered around were operational and could be the key into climbing above to reach the surface. But they should beware that every step they take, the unstable cave shifts little by little to the point where possibly only one miner will be able to escape this infamous nightmare.

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## Task #6 ( 0.29 pts.) - Objectives and Conflicts

Progress: 100%

**Details:**

- Describe the goals and challenges within the game

Your Response:

Players will

- Guide their miner unit of choice through the dead-end cave to find a way to reach the surface again
- Use damaged resources to interact with the environment around them
- Stumble upon different creatures lurking in the cave, posing as a threat to their existence
- Use said resources to break hexagonal tile to find the one that contains an exit
- Have to act quickly due to the unstable cave structure slowly closing in on them and the escape route is only made for one person to get out of

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## Task #7 ( 0.29 pts.) - Game Mechanics

Progress: 100%

**Details:**

- List each mechanic with supporting details to clearly portray the mechanic

Your Response:

- Pickaxe/Bomb/Light card mechanic
- After a player rolls the dice onto a hexagonal tile, they'll be greeted with a random card to aid them in their journey
- Pickaxe cards grants a pickaxe to the player for the chance to break a singular tile space
- Bomb cards grants explosives to the player to explode multiple tiles within its blast radius
- Light cards grants a lamp to the player to display hints in where the escape route will be
- Movement mechanic
- Player will use a 6-sided dice to move across the hexagonal tile map
- Players can only move diagonally
- If tile can't be dug up any further, that tile will become unavailable and the player will skip over it when moving on the map
- Event card mechanic
- After landing on a tile, there's a chance you may stumble into an event card which triggers a favorable or unfavorable moment to you

- A snake event summons a snake to bite and poison you causing it to skip your turn
- A warp event sends you to any random tile on the map
- Bronze/Silver/Gold Tiles mechanic
- Every tile will made of either bronze, silver, or gold material denoting the durability of it through how many picks and/or explosions it could take before breaking and becoming unavailable
- Bronze tiles only need 1 hit to become broken
- Silver tiles only need 2 hits to become broken
- Gold tiles only need 3 hits to become broken

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# Section #2: ( 1 pt.) Target Audience Analysis

Progress: 100%

## Task #1 ( 1 pt.) - Identify and analyze the game's target audience

Progress: 100%

**Details:**

- Clearly identify the target audience
- Include analysis of demographics, interests, and gaming habits
- Justification of appeal to target audience

Your Response:

The target audience my game is courting towards an "everyone" demographic, ignoring limited communities to focus on a broader audience as I hone-in my product to be palatable from anyone ranging from children who started kindergarten to the elderly in retirement. Studies show a product with a simplified premise helps consumers even of low competitive spirit fully engage with it and my game's approach neatly aligns to that "easy to understand, easy to play" philosophy.

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# Section #3: ( 1 pt.) Accessibility And Inclusivity Strategies

Progress: 100%

## Task #1 ( 1 pt.) - Outline strategies to make your game accessible and inclusive

Progress: 100%

Progress: 100%

**Details:**

- Include considerations for diverse abilities
- Outline inclusivity strategies for a wide audience
- Discuss implementation of noted inclusivity strategies without compromising gameplay

Your Response:

My first step in my diversity initiatives is to localize my game for many languages and simplify certain components tied to anything that could be a language barrier towards other foreign countries during game development such as hinting out events with pictures and not solely just words. Another initiative I'd take is to give every single miner different skin tone reflective to the ones seen all across the world too. My strive for diversity doesn't compromise the gameplay aspect at all and instead enhances the experience by creating an inclusive and safe environment meant for everyone regardless of their identity.

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# Section #4: ( 2 pts.) Pitch Preparation

Progress: 100%

## Task #1 ( 2 pts.) - Pitch

Progress: 100%

**Details:**

- Summarize concept and theme
- Compellingly highlight target audience and unique selling points
- Emphasize how the game stands out in the current market

Your Response:

Hexal Miners is a boardgame where 6 miners find themselves trapped under the wreckage of a recently detonated mine. You and a friend will be able to control one of the surviving miners and compete against each other by traversing through this hellish hexagonal tile-based landscape. This game evokes everlasting existential dread as you will come across obstacles obfuscating your path to freedom, not to mention only one of you can make it out alive so every step matters. No matter if you're a little kid or an elderly person, my game caters towards all demographics to deliver well-rounded fun and laughs with any discernable bias in the between. The unique aspect about my game is it utilizes hexagonal tile based technology to create a map filled with luscious mysteries to explore combined with incorporating helpful items to aid you on your journey that's sure to increase the competitive tension you'll have when competing with a friend or relative. These selling points make my game unconventionally unique

within the current marketplace filled with board games whose movement is about as linear and limited as its freedom to strategize.

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# Section #5: ( 2 pts.) Visualizing The Game Concept

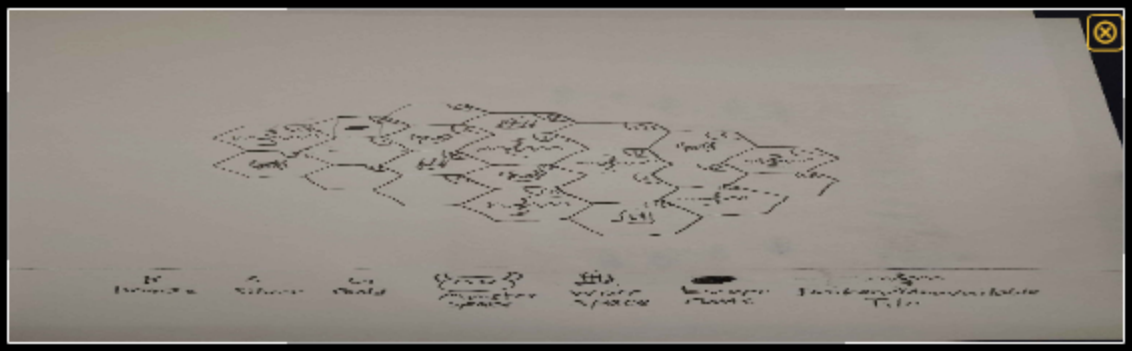
Progress: 100%

## Task #1 ( 2 pts.) - Sketches/Storyboard

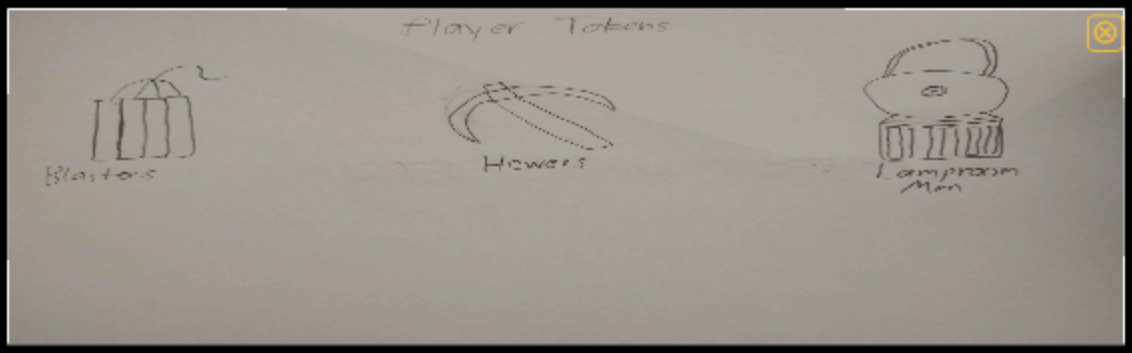
Progress: 100%

**Details:**

- Provide at least two sketches
- Sketches should accurately represent the game's concept and theme
- Sketches/storyboards should be coherent with game's style and theme



Map Overview




Player Tokens Overview

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# Section #6: ( 2 pts.) External Feedback

Progress: 100%

## Task #1 ( 0.67 pts.) - Feedback 1

Progress: 100%

**Details:**

- Note the person's name and relation to you
- Summarize feedback focusing on concept, mechanics, and style
- Reflect on how the feedback will be used to refine the design

Your Response:

Feedback #1: Alex Wyatt, a classmate of mine said he strongly advises against adding any kind of monster combat or fighting mechanics to this game, as it would introduce unnecessary complexity and conflict with your core design philosophy. Introducing monsters as entities to be fought would require additional rules for health, attack power, and turn order, bogging down the "easy to understand, easy to play" experience I'm cultivating for my broad demographic. This feedback helped inspire me to re-adjust the monster feature to be card-based mechanic instead of overall scraping the idea of having monsters in my game.

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## Task #2 ( 0.67 pts.) - Feedback 2

Progress: 100%

**Details:**

- Note the person's name and relation to you
- Summarize feedback focusing on concept, mechanics, and style
- Reflect on how the feedback will be used to refine the design

Your Response:

Another classmate of mine, Henry Russo said to me my target audience is "everyone" but the description of the movement rules ("can only move diagonally" on a hex grid) create immediate confusion and will be a major hurdle for that broad audience. He also mentioned that on a hex grid, the concept of "diagonal" doesn't really exist with movement typically being relegated to any of the six adjacent hexes and only diagonally will force players to constantly reinterpret the board and will slow the game down. With this feedback I'll will scrap the "diagonal only" rule and players will simply be able to move to any adjacent hex as it provides more strategic freedom, which aligns with my unique selling point.

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# Task #3 ( 0.67 pts.) - Feedback 3

Progress: 100%

**Details:**

- Note the person's name and relation to you
- Summarize feedback focusing on concept, mechanics, and style
- Reflect on how the feedback will be used to refine the design

Your Response:

Sebastian Chapman, another classmate of mine said to me that my story and goals strongly emphasize "only one miner will be able to escape" and brought up the current mechanics that read like two players playing separate, parallel solitaire games on the same board. He highlights there's a disconnect between the promise of direct competition and the mechanics described. He suggested that I introduce mechanics that allow players to directly interact with and hinder each other. I thought to myself since the theme is about scarce resources and a single escape, this fits perfectly. For example: what if I implement the feature of the Pickaxe/Bomb cards being used offensively? Like a player could use a bomb not just to clear their own path, but to collapse a tile on top of an opponent, making them waste a turn digging out or forcing them to take a longer route.

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